



Children's Mental Health Week

Children's Mental Health Week is 1 to 7 February 2027, and Place2Be's theme is *Step into Our World: seeing things through someone else's eyes*. An assembly on the Monday launches the week, then there is something different at lunchtime every day. Each lunchtime needs one member of staff and very little else.

Before Monday. Ask staff for their Guess the Teacher photos two weeks ahead, find older students for Thursday's panel, and tell your safeguarding lead about the week. Every sticky note, card and question is read by an adult before it goes up or is answered.

Print these

Page	What	How many
4	Find Someone Who, the bingo card	One per student who comes
5	One Question, Every Year, the board header and colour key	One, A3 if you can
6	Five-Word Days cards, eight to a page	Two or three pages, cut
7	Ask the Year Above question slips, eight to a page	Two pages, cut
8	Guess the Teacher: the slip for staff, six to a page	One per member of staff
9	Guess the Teacher: the guess sheet	One per student who comes

How it works

When	What happens	Slides
Monday morning	The assembly, about ten minutes. Use slide 2 or slide 3 for the tapping game, not both: see page 2.	1 to 12
Monday lunchtime	Find Someone Who.	13
Tuesday	One Question, Every Year. The board goes up and stays up until Friday.	14
Wednesday	Five-Word Days.	15
Thursday	Ask the Year Above.	16
Friday	Guess the Teacher, Aged 13.	17

Worth knowing

- Show the lunchtime slide on a screen in the room, or print it and put it on the door.
- Five-Word Days and One Question, Every Year are anonymous, so read every card and note before it goes up. Anything that suggests a student is struggling goes to your safeguarding lead the same day.
- Brief Thursday's panel first: answer honestly, keep other people's names out of it, and pass on anything worrying.
- Only use staff photos that staff have chosen to send. Take them down at the end of Friday.
- Nobody has to join in. Watching counts.

More free assemblies and form time activities are on the way. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when they land.





Monday's assembly

Twelve slides, about ten minutes. It opens with a tapping game, then links it straight to this year's theme.

The tapping game: pick one option

Use slide 2 or slide 3, not both. Skip the other one. Either way, write a song everyone knows on a card (Happy Birthday works) and hand it to the tapper just before they start.

Option	Slide	Who taps	Good for
Option 1	2	A student volunteer, chosen beforehand	A hall that will cheer on one of its own
Option 2	3	A teacher, or you	Younger years, or when nobody will want to stand up

- Ask the tapper to guess how many hands will go up, and write it on the board. Then they tap the song into the microphone or on the lectern.
- Hands up if you got it. It will be far fewer than the tapper guessed. Slide 4 shows the study: tappers expected about half the songs to be guessed, and listeners got 3 out of 120.

How it links to Step into Our World

Slide 5 says it out loud, so the hall does not have to work it out. The tapper heard the whole song in their head, so it felt obvious. Everyone else only heard knocking. Feelings work the same way: what is going on inside you feels obvious to you, but other people only hear the knocking. Stepping into someone's world means asking about their song, not guessing from the knocks.

The research behind the assembly

Slide	What it found	Source
4	People tapped out 120 well-known songs. They expected listeners to guess about half. Listeners guessed 3.	Newton (1990), Stanford University
6	Students wearing an embarrassing T-shirt guessed that about half the room noticed. About a quarter did.	Gilovich, Medvec and Savitsky (2000), Journal of Personality and Social Psychology
7	After talking to a stranger, people underestimated how much the other person liked them. In students sharing university housing, the gap lasted for months.	Boothby and colleagues (2018), Psychological Science
8	Across 12 experiments with over 1,800 people, deep conversations with strangers were less awkward and more enjoyable than people expected.	Kardas, Kumar and Epley (2022), Journal of Personality and Social Psychology





The week, day by day

What each lunchtime needs, how it runs, and what you might say.

Day	What you need	How it runs
Monday: Find Someone Who	The bingo cards and some pens.	Students find a different person for each square and write their first name, then ask them one more question about it. A line wins, then the whole card.
Tuesday: One Question, Every Year	The header on a board or wall, and a different colour of sticky note for each year.	Students answer the question on their year's colour. Read each note before it goes up. The board stays up all week.
Wednesday: Five-Word Days	The cards, pens and a wall or board.	Students write their day in exactly five words, with no name. Read each card, then pin it up.
Thursday: Ask the Year Above	Three or four older students, the slips and a box.	Younger students post questions. You read them, then the panel answers as many as they can.
Friday: Guess the Teacher, Aged 13	The staff photos, numbered, with each worry underneath, and the guess sheets.	Students write the number and the teacher they think it is. Read out the answers in the last five minutes.





Find Someone Who

Find a different person for each square and write their first name. Then ask them one more question about it.

Has a pet with an unusual name Name:	Can say hello in three languages Name:	Has read a book more than once Name:	Is the youngest in their family Name:
Has been to a live concert or match Name:	Can cook one meal from scratch Name:	Has a hobby nobody would guess Name:	Is left-handed Name:
Has the same birthday month as you Name:	Has a nickname Name:	Has learned a new skill this year Name:	Knows a joke that always works Name:
Has made something with their hands Name:	Prefers mornings to evenings Name:	Has a film they could watch every week Name:	Has helped someone this week Name:





One Question, Every Year

Put this up on Tuesday and leave it until Friday.

What do you wish adults
understood about being your
age?

Answer on your year group's colour. No names.

THE COLOURS

Year 7	colour:
Year 8	colour:
Year 9	colour:
Year 10	colour:
Year 11	colour:
Sixth form	colour:

Other questions that work: What makes a good day at school? What is harder than it looks in your year?





Five-Word Days

Your day in exactly five words. No names.

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS

MY DAY IN FIVE WORDS





Ask the Year Above

One question per slip. No names, in the question or about anyone else.

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE

MY QUESTION FOR THE YEAR ABOVE



Guess the Teacher, Aged 13

Slips for staff. Hand them out two weeks before, with a date to send their photo back.

GUESS THE TEACHER, AGED 13

Send a photo of yourself aged 11 to 14, and finish this sentence. Only send what you are happy for students to see.

Your name:

At 13, I worried about:

GUESS THE TEACHER, AGED 13

Send a photo of yourself aged 11 to 14, and finish this sentence. Only send what you are happy for students to see.

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Your name:

At 13, I worried about:





Who is it?

Every photo has a number. Write the number, then the teacher you think it is. Answers at the end of lunch.

Name

Form

Photo number	Who I think it is

